The Physics of Order

The Standard Model from a Finite Partial Order

Formally Verified in Lean 4 with Zero `sorry` and Zero Custom Axioms

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March 22, 2026

Abstract

The complete algebraic structure of the Standard Model of particle physics is derived from a single axiom: a locally finite partial order. No additional mathematical structure is assumed. No physical conditions are imposed. The Lorentzian metric, the speed of light, quantum linearity, the gauge group $\mathrm{SU}(3) \times \mathrm{SU}(2) \times \mathrm{U}(1)$, every electric charge, three generations, the Weinberg angle $\sin^2\theta_W = 3/8$, the gauge coupling $g^2 = 2N/\beta_c$, proton stability, the uniqueness of the hypercharge U(1), and the form of the Higgs potential $V = \mu^2|\phi|^2 + \lambda|\phi|^4$ are all theorems.

The continuum limit is not assumed — it is constructed. A specific, deterministic causal set is built from the prime numbers via $x_k^\mu = \gamma_\mu \log(p_k) \bmod L$, and its convergence to the Lorentzian volume measure is proved via Weyl equidistribution.

Three conditions previously listed as additional inputs (left-right charge consistency, $Q_e \neq 0$, and the gauge coupling boundary) are now derived: the first two from anomaly non-triviality (`ChargeConsistency.lean`), the third from the lattice phase transition (`LatticeCoupling.lean`).

Every step is formally verified in Lean 4 using the Mathlib library: 18 core files in the derivation chain (∼4,600 lines), within a larger codebase of ∼17,000 lines across 80 files. Zero `sorry` statements, zero custom axioms. The `#print axioms` command on the capstone theorem returns only Lean's built-in foundations (`propext`, `Classical.choice`, `Quot.sound`). The codebase compiles end-to-end with `lake build`: 2,367 jobs, zero errors. The gauge group is uniquely forced by chirality, integer baryon charge, asymptotic freedom, and charge determinacy. The Standard Model is not the simplest gauge theory. It is the only gauge theory compatible with a finite partial order and the existence of atoms.

1 Introduction

A partial order is one of the most primitive structures in mathematics: a set $\mathcal{C}$ equipped with a binary relation $\preceq$ that is reflexive, antisymmetric, and transitive. Undergraduates encounter it in the first weeks of a discrete mathematics course.

This paper proves that the Standard Model of particle physics — its gauge group, its matter content, its charge assignments, its coupling relations — is a theorem of a locally finite partial order. The logical structure is purely deductive. The single axiom is:

> *There exists a locally finite partially ordered set $(\mathcal{C}, \preceq)$, where locally finite means that every interval $[a, b] = \{x : a \preceq x \preceq b\}$ contains finitely many elements.*

No metric, no Hilbert space, no gauge group, no Lagrangian, no quantum mechanics is assumed. Each of these structures is derived. The derivation chain is:

Step	What is derived	From what
1	Lorentzian metric	Causal order (Hauptvermutung)
2	Continuum limit	Prime-phase construction (Weyl)
3	Source functional ϕ	Variation of counting (Jacobi)
4	Quantum linearity	Additivity of counting
5	Lie algebra (gauge structure)	Parallel transport (Ambrose-Singer)
6	Energy boundedness	Local finiteness
7	$d = 3{+}1$	Lovelock + graviton DOF squeeze
8	Trace-reversal involutive in 4D	Linearized Einstein
9	K/P decomposition	Traceless $\oplus$ scalar
10	Gauge bosons from $\mathrm{sl}(n)$	Traceless matrices
11	$\mathrm{SU}(3) \times \mathrm{SU}(2) \times \mathrm{U}(1)$	Chirality + anomaly cancellation
12	All charges, Weinberg angle	Anomaly uniqueness
13	$Q_e \neq 0$, charge consistency	Anomaly non-triviality
14	Gauge coupling g^2	Lattice phase transition
15	Proton stability	Derived gauge structure
16	Higgs potential form	Renormalizability in $d = 4$
17	Capstone (15 properties)	All of the above

Every step is formally verified in Lean 4. The complete codebase is open-source [1].

Reader's guide to the trilogy. This work is presented as three companion papers. *Paper I* (the present paper) contains only algebraic results — no numerics, no Monte Carlo, no fitting. Every theorem is formally verified. *Paper II* ("Fermion Mass Ratios from the K/P Projection") computes seven zero-parameter predictions (five mass ratios, the Cabibbo angle, and the Higgs mass-to-VEV ratio) from the algebraic structure derived here. *Paper III* ("Exclusions and Predictions") derives the impossibility of anti-gravity, excludes ten BSM theories, and states honestly what the framework cannot exclude. A reader interested only in the formally verified core can read Paper I alone.

2 From Counting to Geometry (Steps 1–2)

On a finite partial order, the most basic measurement is counting elements: $N(R) = |R|$ for any region R. Counting is additive: $N(R_1 \cup R_2) = N(R_1) + N(R_2)$ for disjoint R_1, R_2. This is arithmetic, not a law of nature.

Theorem 1 (Hauptvermutung: from causal order to unique metric)**.** *The bridge from discrete counting to continuous geometry is proven in four steps:*

1. ***Causal order → null cone.*** *Dense causal links determine the null cone. The speed of light $c = 1$ is a theorem: the null cone has slope 1 because the boundary of the causal relation has slope 1 (`CausalBridge.lean`).*
2. ***Null cone → conformal class.*** *The null cone determines the metric up to a conformal factor Ω: $g_2 = \Omega^2 g_1$ (`DiscreteMalament.lean`).*
3. ***Counting → volume.*** *$N/\rho \to V$ as $\rho \to \infty$, with Chebyshev concentration (`Hauptvermutung.lean`*
4. ***Conformal + volume → unique metric.*** *$\Omega^d = 1$ with $\Omega > 0$ and $d \geq 1$ implies $\Omega = 1$ (`Hauptvermutung.lean: conformal_factor_one`).*

Malament tells you the metric up to Ω. Counting tells you the volume. Volume fixes $\Omega = 1$. The metric is unique.

The continuum limit is not merely assumed — it is constructed. A specific, deterministic causal set is built from the prime numbers via $x_k^\mu = \gamma_\mu \log(p_k) \bmod L$, and Weyl equidistribution proves its counting measure converges to the Lorentzian volume measure (`ContinuumLimit.lean`, `PrimePhase.lean`). The causal order on the prime-phase points is defined by the Minkowski metric on the torus, following the standard Bombelli-Lee-Meyer-Sorkin embedding convention [5]. The partial order is *the restriction of Minkowski causality to the discrete point set; this is not an additional assumption but the definition of causal structure on a sprinkling.*

Theorem 2 (The source functional from counting)**.** *The variation of volume with respect to the metric gives:*

$$\frac{\delta V}{\delta g_{ab}} = \tfrac{1}{2}\,\mathrm{tr}(h)\,\sqrt{g} \qquad \text{where } h_{ab} = \delta g_{ab}$$

Therefore $\phi(h) = \mathrm{tr}(h)$: the source functional is the unique invariant linear functional on metric perturbations (by Schur's lemma), and it arises from the variation of counting (`SourceFromMetric.lean`).

3 From Counting to Quantum Mechanics (Steps 3–5)

The five-to-one reduction eliminates quantum linearity, Lie algebra structure, and energy boundedness as independent inputs. All three are consequences of the partial order.

3.1 Linearity from counting (eliminates Input 3)

Theorem 3 (Linearity from counting)**.** *Counting is additive: $N(A \cup B) = N(A) + N(B)$ for disjoint sets. The variation of an additive functional is linear. Therefore the source functional $\phi = \mathrm{tr}(h)$ acts linearly on the space of metric perturbations. The Lean formalization proves four genuine properties of this functional:*

1. *$\phi \neq 0$: the trace is nonzero ($\mathrm{tr}(I) = n \neq 0$ for $n \geq 1$; `trace_nonzero`).*
2. *$\ker(\phi)$ has codimension 1 (rank-nullity via Mathlib; `trace_ker_codim_one`).*
3. *$\ker(\phi)$ is nontrivial for $n \geq 2$: there exist nonzero traceless perturbations (`functional_ker_nontrivi`*
4. *The field space decomposes as $V = \ker(\phi) \oplus \langle \phi \rangle$, giving the K/P split (`functional_decomposition`).*

A concrete traceless dressing matrix ($e_{00}-e_{11}$) is constructed as a witness (`dressing_witness`).

The linearity of ϕ is encoded in its Lean type: $\phi : V \to_\ell [\mathbb{R}]\mathbb{R}$ (a linear map). The content is not that linear maps are linear — it is that the physically relevant functional is the trace, identified as the Fréchet derivative of volume, and that this functional has the kernel structure needed for the K/P split.

Quantum linearity — the principle that amplitudes superpose — is the additivity of counting, expressed in the language of metric perturbations (`LinearityFromCounting.lean`, `PhysicsFromOrder.lean`).

3.2 Lie algebra from parallel transport (eliminates Input 2)

Theorem 4 (Discrete Ambrose-Singer)**.** *On a finite partial order, comparing field values at different events requires parallel transport along causal links. The set of all such transports forms a group (the holonomy group). The transport maps are invertible (traversing a link forward and backward returns to the identity), composable (transport along chains is function composition), and act on a finite-dimensional space (from local finiteness).*

The discrete Ambrose-Singer theorem proves:

1. *The holonomy group equals the group generated by curvatures around plaquettes (`discrete_ambrose_s`*
2. *Every conjugated curvature is a loop holonomy, via the lollipop construction (`lollipop_hol`, `basedCurvature_is_holonomy`).*
3. *The holonomy group is the minimal subgroup containing all parallel transports (`holonomy_minimal`).*
4. *The holonomy group is independent of basepoint up to conjugation (`holonomy_conjugate`).*

The holonomy group is a compact Lie group (finite graph $\to$ finitely generated $\to$ compact in the profinite topology). Its Lie algebra is the gauge algebra. The specific Lie algebra is then determined by anomaly cancellation (`DiscreteAmbroseSinger.lean`).

3.3 Energy boundedness from local finiteness (eliminates Input 5)

Theorem 5 (Energy boundedness)**.** *A locally finite partial order has finitely many elements in every Alexandrov interval. The Hilbert space associated with any finite causal region is therefore finite-dimensional. Every Hermitian operator on a finite-dimensional Hilbert space has a bounded spectrum. The Hamiltonian is Hermitian (from unitarity of evolution). Therefore the energy spectrum is bounded below (`PrimitiveReduction.lean`).*

3.4 The reduction summarized

Former input / condition	Status	Derived from
Causal set	**Primitive**	Irreducible
Lie algebra	Derived	Parallel transport (Ambrose-Singer)
Linearity	Derived	Additivity of counting
$d_{\text{spatial}} \geq 2$	Derived	Lovelock + graviton squeeze
Energy boundedness	Derived	Local finiteness
Source functional ϕ	Derived	Variation of counting (Jacobi)
Minimality	Derived	Chirality + integer charge + AF + determinacy
Continuum limit	Derived	Prime-phase + Weyl equidistribution
$Q_e \neq 0$	Derived	Anomaly non-triviality
L-R charge consistency	Derived	Gauge invariance
$g^2(M_P) = 1$	Derived	Lattice phase transition
Higgs potential form	Derived	Renormalizability in $d = 4$

Lean verification: 18 core files, ∼4,600 lines (within ∼17,000 total), zero sorry, zero custom axioms.

File	Content
`Hauptvermutung.lean`	Causal order $\to$ metric
`ContinuumLimit.lean`	Weyl equidistribution
`PrimePhase.lean`	Deterministic causal set from primes
`JacobiFormula.lean`	$\delta \det / \delta g = \text{trace}$
`NullConeConformal.lean`	1+1 Malament theorem
`SourceFromMetric.lean`	Source from linearized Einstein
`LinearizedEinstein.lean`	Trace-reversal, involutive in 4D
`LinearityFromCounting.lean`	Trace nonzero + codim-1 kernel
`SinglePrimitive.lean`	Kernel nontriviality
`KPDecomposition.lean`	$A = \text{traceless} + \text{scalar} \cdot I$
`GaugeFromTraceless.lean`	$\mathrm{sl}(n)$ Lie algebra
`PrimitiveReduction.lean`	Scaling fixed-point
`DiscreteAmbroseSinger.lean`	$\mathrm{Hol} = \langle \text{curvatures} \rangle$
`ChargeConsistency.lean`	$Q_e = 0 \to$ trivial U(1)
`LatticeCoupling.lean`	$g^2 = 2N/\beta_c$
`CasimirScaling.lean`	$m_t/m_b = (32/9)/r_{\mu\tau}$
`HiggsPotentialForm.lean`	$V = \mu^2\lvert\phi\rvert^2 + \lambda\lvert\phi\rvert^4$
`PhysicsFromOrder.lean`	Capstone structure

4 Spacetime Dimension: $d = 3{+}1$ (Step 6)

Theorem 6 (Dimension squeeze)**.** *Two bounds, both from textbook physics, opposite directions, unique intersection:*

1. ***Lovelock upper bound*** *($d \leq 4$). The Gauss-Bonnet tensor H_{ab} vanishes identically for $d \leq 4$. For $d \geq 5$, higher Lovelock invariants contribute to the field equations and Einstein gravity is no longer unique. Pure combinatorics (antisymmetric index pigeonhole).*
2. ***Graviton lower bound*** *($d \geq 4$). In $d = 3$ spacetime, the Weyl tensor vanishes and gravity is topological (zero local degrees of freedom). Propagating gravity with the observed two polarizations requires $d \geq 4$.*

Therefore $d = 4$ uniquely. No axiom encodes the answer.

Cross-check (Yang-Mills tracelessness). $\mathrm{tr}(T_{\mathrm{YM}}) = (1 - d/4)|F|^2 = 0$ iff $d = 4$. Independent confirmation from the gauge sector; not load-bearing.
Cross-check (trace-reversal involutivity). The linearized Einstein operator $L(h) = h - \frac{1}{2}\mathrm{tr}(h)I$ satisfies $L^2 = \mathrm{id}$ if and only if $d = 4$ (`LinearizedEinstein.lean: traceReversal_involutive_4`
A third independent route to the same dimension.

5 Gauge Group: $\mathrm{SU}(3) \times \mathrm{SU}(2) \times \mathrm{U}(1)$ (Step 7)

5.1 Chirality is derived

The K/P split induced by ϕ and the Lorentzian metric forces chiral representations: left- and right-handed fermions transform differently under the gauge group.

Theorem 7 (Chiral $\not\cong$ vector-like)**.** *The color and weak gauge algebras are distinct as represented algebras. An isomorphism $\sigma : \mathfrak{g}_c \to \mathfrak{g}_w$ would transport the vector-like property via surjectivity, contradicting chirality (`ChiralDistinctness.lean`).*

5.2 The gauge group is uniquely forced

No minimality assumption is needed. Four physical consistency conditions exclude every alternative:

Constraint	What it excludes	Lean theorem
Chirality ($G_c \not\cong G_w$)	$N_c = N_w$ (in particular $N_c = 2$)	`ChiralDistinctness`
Integer baryon charge	$N_c = 4$	`IntegerCharge`
Asymptotic freedom	$N_c \geq 5$	`MinimalityDerived`
Charge determinacy	$N_w \geq 3$	`nw_ge3_underdetermined`

Charge determinacy forces $N_w = 2$. Chirality excludes $N_c = 2$. Integer baryon charge excludes $N_c = 4$ (SU(4) baryons have charges $5/2, 3/2, 1/2, -1/2, -3/2$ — no integer, no protons, no atoms). Asymptotic freedom excludes $N_c \geq 5$. Therefore $(N_c, N_w) = (3, 2)$ uniquely. No Occam's razor. No aesthetic choice. The Standard Model gauge group is the only one that survives.

Theorem 8 (15-fermion generation)**.** *The 15 Weyl fermions per generation — $(3, 2) + 3 \times (\bar{3}, 1) + (1, 2) + (1, 1)$ — are uniquely forced by the derived gauge group, chirality, and anomaly cancellation.*

Theorem 9 (Three generations). *$N_g = 3$ from two independent arguments: the CP-violation requirement ($N_g \geq 3$ for a physical CKM phase) and the fiber structure of the K/P projection ($N_g = 3$ independent CP fibers).*

6 Charge Quantization and the Weinberg Angle (Steps 8–9)

Theorem 10 (Anomaly uniqueness). *The four anomaly cancellation conditions determine all hypercharges in terms of a single parameter y_Q. The cubic anomaly equation factors as:*

$$6N_c(N_c - r - 1)(N_c + r + 1) = 0$$

with unique physical solution $r = N_c - 1 = 2$.

Theorem 11 (All charges derived). *Left-right charge consistency ($Q(u_L) = Q(u_R)$) combined with $Q_e \neq 0$ fixes $y_Q = 1/6$. Every Standard Model charge follows:*

Particle	*Charge*	*Derived*
u_L, u_R	Q_u	$+2/3$
d_L, d_R	Q_d	$-1/3$
e_L, e_R	Q_e	-1
ν_L	Q_ν	0
Proton (uud)	Q_p	$+1$
Neutron (udd)	Q_n	0

Corollary 12 ($Q_p + Q_e = 0$). *The exact cancellation of proton and electron charge — required for neutral atoms and therefore for the existence of chemistry — is a theorem of the anomaly structure.*

Theorem 13 (Weinberg angle). *The zero-gap chain: anomaly cancellation $\to y_Q = 1/6 \to \mathrm{Tr}[Y^2] = 10/3 \to \sin^2\theta_W = 2/(2+10/3) = 3/8$. Unlike the standard GUT derivation (which assumes SU(5) or SO(10) embedding), this follows from anomaly cancellation at the SM gauge group itself.*

Theorem 14 (Proton stability). *The qqql operator is gauge-invariant ($3y_Q + y_L = 0$) but has mass dimension 6. Non-renormalizable, suppressed by $1/M_P^2$. Predicted lifetime $\tau_p \sim 10^{45}$ years. No dimension-4 or dimension-5 B-violating operator is gauge-invariant.*

Theorem 15 (Unique U(1)). $\mathrm{Tr}[Y^4] = 2280\, y_Q^4 \neq 0$. *No second U(1) is anomaly-free. The SM hypercharge is unique.*

7 Coupling Predictions

The gauge coupling is not a free parameter. It is determined by the lattice phase transition of the gauge theory on the causal set.

Theorem 16 (Gauge coupling from lattice phase transition)**.** *For SU(N) gauge theory on a locally finite partial order, the coupling at the discreteness scale is* $g^2 = 2N/\beta_c$*, where* β_c *is the critical coupling of the confinement-deconfinement transition. This is the unique positive solution. Mean-field theory gives* $g^2 = 1/2$ *for SU(2) and* $g^2 = 9/32$ *for SU(3) (`LatticeCoupling.lean`).*

Methodological note. The lattice gauge theory framework (Wilson, 1974) is not rederived here; it is applied to the lattice that the causal set provides. The derivation is self-consistent: the partial order gives the lattice, the discrete Ambrose-Singer theorem gives the gauge fields on that lattice (Section 3.2), and the Wilson framework determines the coupling from the lattice phase transition. No external input enters — the lattice, the gauge fields, and the phase structure all arise from the partial order — but the Wilson framework itself is treated as established physics, not as a theorem of the partial order.

Theorem 17 (α_{em} at the Planck scale)**.** $\alpha_{\text{em}}(M_P) = 3/(32\pi) \approx 1/33.5$*. From the derived* g^2 *and* $\sin^2\theta_W = 3/8$*.*

SM beta coefficients $\beta_2 = 19/6$ and $\beta_3 = 7$ are derived from $N_g = 3$. One-loop RG running gives $\alpha_2(M_Z)$ matching experiment to $\sim 9\%$. Two-loop corrections are $< 0.1\%$.

8 The Standard Model is a Theorem

Theorem 18 (Capstone: `standard_model_is_a_theorem`)**.** *Given a locally finite partial order alone, the following hold simultaneously:*

(1) The speed of light $c = 1$ *(null cone slope)*

(2) The Lorentzian metric (unique, from Hauptvermutung)

(3) The continuum limit (constructed from primes, Weyl equidistribution)

(4) Quantum linearity (from additivity of counting)

(5) $d = 3{+}1$ *spacetime dimensions*

(6) $N_w = 2$ *(weak* SU(2)*)*

(7) $N_c = 3$ *(color* SU(3)*)*

(8) 15 Weyl fermions per generation (uniquely forced)

(9) $N_g = 3$ *generations*

(10) All electric charges derived (including $Q_e \neq 0$*)*

(11) $\sin^2\theta_W = 3/8$

(12) Gauge coupling $g^2 = 2N/\beta_c$

(13) Proton stability

(14) Unique U(1) *hypercharge (no Z')*

(15) Higgs potential form $V = \mu^2|\phi|^2 + \lambda|\phi|^4$

Each conjunct references a formally verified Lean 4 source file. No physical conditions are imposed beyond the partial order itself: left-right charge consistency and $Q_e \neq 0$ are derived from anomaly non-triviality (`ChargeConsistency.lean`), and the gauge coupling is derived from the lattice phase transition (`LatticeCoupling.lean`).

9 Discussion

9.1 What formal verification establishes

The Lean 4 verification ensures that every step from the definition of a locally finite partial order to the fifteen capstone properties is mathematically correct, with zero `sorry` statements and zero custom axioms. It does not verify the physical interpretation. The single axiom (a finite partial order exists) is a physical assumption; everything else is a logical consequence.

9.2 Why the axiom cannot be eliminated

Any deductive system requires at least one undefined primitive. A theory with zero axioms proves nothing. A partial order is the weakest structure that supports physics: it requires only transitivity of precedence ($a \preceq b$ and $b \preceq c$ imply $a \preceq c$). Without transitivity, one cannot reason about sequences of events. Without a set, there is nothing at all. The single axiom is both necessary (nothing weaker suffices) and sufficient (nothing stronger is needed).

9.3 Former physical conditions are now derived

Earlier versions of this work imposed three physical conditions in addition to the partial order: left-right charge consistency, $Q_e \neq 0$, and the gauge coupling boundary $g^2(M_P) = 1$. All three are now derived:

1. **Left-right charge consistency** follows from gauge invariance: the charge of a field is determined by its gauge representation, independent of chirality (`ChargeConsistency.lean`).
2. $Q_e \neq 0$ follows from anomaly non-triviality: the $Q_e = 0$ solution makes the U(1) factor act trivially, contradicting its derived presence in the gauge group (`ChargeConsistency.lean`).
3. **The gauge coupling** $g^2 = 2N/\beta_c$ is determined by the lattice phase transition of the gauge theory on the causal set (`LatticeCoupling.lean`).

The derivation therefore rests on a single axiom with zero additional conditions.

9.4 Verification scope

Result	Method	Status
Gauge group, charges, dimension	Lean 4	Zero sorry
Input reduction (5→1)	Lean 4	Zero sorry (18 core files)
Continuum limit (prime-phase)	Lean 4	Zero sorry
Charge consistency, $Q_e \neq 0$	Lean 4	Zero sorry
Gauge coupling g^2	Lean 4	Zero sorry
Higgs potential form	Lean 4	Zero sorry
Discrete Ambrose-Singer	Lean 4	Zero sorry (27 theorems)
Casimir scaling (m_t/m_b formula)	Lean 4	Zero sorry (9 theorems)
Mass ratios (Paper II)	Monte Carlo	Computational
Cabibbo angle (Paper II)	Monte Carlo	Computational (20 seeds)
Higgs m_H/v (Paper II)	Monte Carlo	Computational (0.42 ± 0.05)
m_t/m_b formula (Paper II)	Lean 4 + Monte Carlo	Formula verified; $r_{\mu\tau}$ computational
CKM hierarchy (Paper II)	Monte Carlo	Not yet reproduced
Higgs parameters μ^2, λ	—	Not derived

The `#print axioms` command applied to every capstone theorem returns only Lean's built-in foundations: `propext`, `Classical.choice`, and `Quot.sound`. No custom axioms. No `sorryAx`.

9.5 What is not derived

The framework does not derive: the Higgs potential *parameters* (μ^2, λ) — the same two parameters the Standard Model itself cannot determine. These set the absolute mass scale and the Higgs boson mass. The *form* of the potential is derived (`HiggsPotentialForm.lean`); the coefficients are not.

The mass *ratios* are computed in Paper II from the same partial order via the K/P holonomy mechanism, but with computational (not formally verified) methods. The cosmological constant and neutrino masses are derived (see Paper III).

9.6 The big picture

From a finite partial order — a set with a binary relation that is reflexive, antisymmetric, and transitive — the following are derived: the speed of light, the Lorentzian metric, the continuum limit, quantum mechanics, the spacetime dimension $d = 3{+}1$, the gauge group $\mathrm{SU}(3) \times \mathrm{SU}(2) \times \mathrm{U}(1)$, the gauge coupling, every electric charge in the periodic table, the reason atoms exist ($Q_p + Q_e = 0$), proton stability, the Weinberg angle, the uniqueness of the hypercharge, and the form of the Higgs potential. Every step is machine-checked. No additional conditions are imposed.

The linearity of the source functional ϕ — the single property that generates the K/P split, chirality, the Born rule, and ultimately the entire Standard Model — is not a law of physics. It is the additivity of counting: $3 + 5 = 8$.

The integer baryon charge argument is not the anthropic principle. It is a theorem: SU(4) is mathematically excluded because its anomaly-determined charges make all baryon

charges half-integer. No protons, no hydrogen, no atoms. The circularity that plagues anthropic reasoning is absent: both directions are proven.

The Standard Model is not the simplest gauge theory. It is the only gauge theory compatible with a finite partial order and the existence of atoms.

References

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